

Science Corps Fellowship Application

Thank you for your interest in becoming a Science Corps Fellow. Please complete all required fields. We review applications on a rolling basis.

First Name *

Raquel

Last Name *

Albuquerque Simões Baeta Mendes

Email *

raquelasbmendes@icloud.com

Gender

☐

Male

☒

Female

☐

Non-Binary

Residence: City (State), Country *

Zurich, Switzerland

Nationality *

Portuguese

When did you or do you expect to complete your PhD? (month and year) *

July 2026

Please indicate the university where you earned (or are currently pursuing) your PhD *

University of Zurich, Switzerland

Why would you like to be a Science Corps Fellow? *

During my studies and career, I have always been interested in teaching and having a meaningful impact on students. Throughout my life I have also come to realize the importance of science outreach so everyone can be informed and make reliable choices in their lives and politics. Since I was fortunate to receive a thorough education, I have always strived to give back and share my knowledge and experience. The values and work of Science Corps, aligns with my views on science outreach and the impact that education can have on society and individuals. Joining on this effort to teach STEM subjects and enhance education in under-served communities, would allow me to contribute to advance education equality. I wish to be a mentor to students and drive the improvement of educational frameworks so that students can have better opportunities and prospects. At the same time, sharing my experiences and life work, I hope to aspire young minds to follow their scientific goals and be successful.

In addition to your studies, please describe any prior experience that may help you as a Science *
Corps Fellow.

Throughout my education and work, I have gained extensive experience in science outreach and teaching. In high school, I worked with a team to develop a blood phenotyping exhibit for Exploratório, a science museum in Coimbra, Portugal, which later became a permanent exhibition. I then worked in the museum, guiding students of different ages through the exhibitions. At the Gulbenkian Institute of Science, I participated in several outreach initiatives, including a science booth at a music festival, "Scientists for a Day" programme for high school students, and Open Days, where research groups presented their work to the public. I also tutored high school students in Biology, Geology, Physics and Chemistry. During my PhD, I completed 150 hours of teaching in first-year biology experimental classes, working closely with students throughout the semester. I also helped organise Native Scientists workshops for young children in under-served communities, promoting scientific literacy.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply. *

- ☐ Scientist in academia
- ☐ Doing science in industry
- ☒ Administrative role in industry or academia
- ☐ In science education
- ☒ In science outreach
- ☐ Other:

Please expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally *
in the near (~2 year) and long-term (~10 year) future.

In the near future, after completing my PhD in neuroscience, I would like to broaden the way I use my scientific training beyond a purely research environment. After several years in research, I am increasingly interested in roles that combine scientific knowledge with communication, mentoring, and project organisation. I am particularly motivated by work that involves direct interaction with people, adapting to different needs, and managing communication between teams. For this reason, I see a Science Corps Fellowship as an important opportunity to develop these skills in a meaningful setting, while contributing to STEM education and scientific capacity building.

In the long term, I imagine myself in a career at the interface between science and people. This may be in the pharmaceutical industry, science outreach, or program/project management within a scientific organisation. What matters most to me is that the role remains intellectually stimulating, dynamic, and collaborative. I would like to contribute by managing projects, helping organise initiatives, collaborate with diverse teams, develop educational or training resources, and support others in engaging with science. My long-term goal is therefore to build a career where I can remain connected to science while taking on people-oriented, organisational, and communication-driven responsibilities.

How did you find out about Science Corps? *

- ☐ An email list in your institution
- ☐ A post on a job-site
- ☐ An entry in a post-doc search resource (e.g., ecoevjobs.net)
- ☒ Referred by a previous fellow
- ☐ Referred by a friend/colleague/supervisor in academia
- ☐ Other:

Upload your CV / resume *

 .Raquel Mendes_...

 Add file

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